

THE CRUCIBLE: ACT 1 MATRIX ACTIVITY

Power Dynamics, Underlying Motives, and the Escalation of Accusations

STUDENT NAME: _____

DATE: _____

CLASS PERIOD: _____

Activity Directions: Complete the matrix below by analyzing how individual motives, fears, and community power structures drive the events in Salem during Act 1.

FOCUS / FIGURE	CORE MOTIVE & FEAR	KEY ACTIONS IN ACT 1	SYNTHESIS & ANALYSIS
SALEM COMMUNITY <i>Theocracy vs. Individualism</i>	Why was theocracy created? _____ _____	Why are settlers shifting to individualism? _____ _____	Analysis Checkpoint: How does strict societal control create room for mass panic? _____
REVEREND PARRIS <i>Minister of Salem</i>	Primary Concern/Fear: _____ _____	Attitude Toward Parishioners: _____ _____	Conflict Analysis: Why is John Proctor opposed to Parris's leadership? _____
THE PUTNAM FAMILY <i>Thomas & Ann Putnam</i>	Thomas Putnam's Goal: _____ _____	Ann Putnam's Secret Action: Why did she send Ruth to the woods? _____	Motive Tracker: How do land disputes and grief motivate witch accusations? _____
ABIGAIL WILLIAMS <i>Orphan / Former Servant</i>	Desire & Feelings: Attitude toward John & Elizabeth Proctor: _____ _____	Treatment of Others: How she treats the girls vs. Rev. Parris: _____ _____	Deceit Check: Why does Abigail confess that Tituba/Ruth conjured spirits? _____
REV. HALE & TITUBA <i>Interrogation Scene</i>	Hale's Interrogation Technique: How does Hale lead Tituba? _____	Tituba's Reaction: Why does Tituba begin naming names? _____	Climax of Act I: Why do Abigail and Betty join in hysterical naming? _____

ACT I EXIT CHECKPOINT QUESTION

Why do John Proctor and Rebecca Nurse stand against Reverend Hale's arrival, and what does Rebecca's eventual exit signal to everyone remaining in Betty's room?

